AMITY UNIVERSITY

UTTAR PRADESH

Amity Institute of Education

ACTION RESEARCH ON CLASSROOM DISCIPLINE IN CLASS VIII B

A Report Submitted to

Amity University Uttar Pradesh

in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF EDUCATION (B.Ed.)

Submitted By

KRISHNA MAHATO

Enrolment Number: Withheld

AMITY INSTITUTE OF EDUCATION

AMITY UNIVERSITY UTTAR PRADESH

Noida

Batch: 2025-27

AMITY UNIVERSITY

UTTAR PRADESH

Amity Institute of Education

DECLARATION

I, Krishna Mahato, student of Amity Institute of Education, hereby declare that the report titled "Action Research on Classroom Discipline in Class VIII B", submitted by me to Amity Institute of Education, Amity University Uttar Pradesh, in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Education (B.Ed.), is based on the school internship work I carried out. This report has not previously formed the basis for the award of any degree, diploma or other similar title or recognition.

I have acknowledged the sources used in preparing the report and protected the identities of the school and students. The school is referred to as XYZ, and student names are not disclosed.

Place: Noida

Date: _____

Name: Krishna Mahato

Enrolment Number: Withheld

Signature

AMITY UNIVERSITY

UTTAR PRADESH

Amity Institute of Education

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I express my sincere thanks to the faculty members of Amity Institute of Education, Amity University Uttar Pradesh, for the guidance and support that helped me complete my school internship and prepare this report.

I am grateful to the principal and teachers of School XYZ for the opportunity to work with Class VIII B. I thank the students for their participation in collaborative classroom management and the positive recognition system. Working with them helped me reflect on classroom expectations, my relationship with the class and the conditions needed for learning.

I also thank my fellow interns and batchmates for their cooperation during the internship. Their companionship was valuable while I balanced classroom teaching with observation and reflection. I remain responsible for the interpretations and conclusions presented in this report.

Krishna Mahato

TABLE OF CONTENTS

No.	Contents	Page
1	Preliminary details	1
2	Introduction and statement of the problem	1
3	Need for the study	2
4	Objectives research questions and action hypothesis	2
5	Theoretical grounding linked to practice	3
6	Research design and methodology	4
7	Operational definitions and observation parameters	4
8	Baseline observations	5
9	Collaborative classroom management	5
10	Positive recognition system	6
11	Relationship between the two activities and the outcome	6
12	Findings and interpretation	7
13	Discussion and professional reflection	8
14	Researcher bias reliability and ethical limits	8
15	Recommendations and future action research	9
16	Conclusion	10
17	References	11

Action Research on Classroom Discipline in Class VIII B

B.Ed School Internship Report

Structured non-punitive classroom management

Preliminary details

Particular	Record
School and venue	School XYZ, Class VIII B and associated school routines
Participants	One intact class of 38 students
Initial observation period	17 to 31 July 2026
Classroom work covered	Initial observation and the two activities conducted before the examination period
Implemented activities	Collaborative classroom management and a positive recognition system
Nature of inquiry	Practitioner action research using observation parameters and reflective field notes
What I observed	I noticed a slight improvement in discipline as students became more familiar with me.

1. Introduction and statement of the problem

I undertook this inquiry because recurring discipline difficulties in Class VIII B were interfering with teaching and students' opportunity to learn. My initial observations included failure to follow instructions, arguments among students, occasional physical conflict and arguments with teachers. Planned activities could not always be conducted properly. The problem affected students who wanted to study as well as those involved in disruption.

I used collaborative classroom management and a positive recognition system in response. Before the examination period, I observed a slight improvement in discipline as students became more familiar with me. In my judgement, the two activities helped, but familiarity and the developing teacher–student relationship were also part of the change. I cannot separate their effects or express the improvement as a measured percentage.

I have brought this inquiry to a close with the classroom work I completed before examinations. I had originally planned to continue into October, but examinations, festivals and the need to complete the remaining chapters left little time for further observation. I therefore based my final reflection on the two activities I conducted and the changes I had observed by that stage.

I wanted to understand how I could improve classroom discipline as an intern teacher through structured, non-punitive approaches. I understood discipline as safe, respectful conduct that allowed learning to continue. I did not expect silence throughout every lesson: questions, discussion and movement could support learning as long as they did not prevent others from participating.

2. Need for the study

I chose this problem because it affected my ordinary teaching. When students did not follow instructions or an argument interrupted an activity, I found it difficult to maintain the lesson. Repeated correction also took attention away from students who were ready to learn. I noted the discouragement this caused and its effect on interested students.

The inquiry gave me an opportunity to examine my own classroom practice. I needed approaches that I could use consistently within my role. At first, I focused on the difference between my authority and that of a regular teacher. As I reflected on the problem, I also considered the clarity of my expectations, my relationship with students and the way I acknowledged desirable conduct.

I noticed that students were comparatively more disciplined with their regular teachers. Arguments still occurred, but appeared more limited in those lessons. I initially considered a difference in perceived authority as one possible explanation. I also recognised that familiarity, established routines, relationships and continuity of follow-up could contribute. Since I did not interview students about their motives or conduct matched observations across teachers, I could not establish a single cause.

3. Objectives research questions and action hypothesis

I wanted to identify the main forms of disruption, try suitable non-punitive strategies, observe whether discipline improved and reflect on my developing relationship with students. My purpose was to improve my work with this class. I was not attempting to establish the effectiveness of a management programme across different schools.

Research question	What I could use to answer it	What I could not establish
What difficulties affected teaching?	Initial observations of instructions, conflict and disruption	No frequency tally for each behaviour
What change followed the two activities?	My later observation of slight improvement	No precise numerical estimate or independent confirmation
How did familiarity with me relate to conduct?	My reflection that discipline improved as familiarity increased	Association, not proof of causation
What should continue after this inquiry?	Reflection on the problem and intervention	Recommendations, not additional completed research

I expected that a structured, non-punitive approach would help me improve discipline, participation and lesson continuity during the internship. I kept this expectation directional rather than setting a precise percentage target. By the end of my inquiry, I had noticed a slight improvement in discipline, but I had not measured participation and lesson completion separately.

4. Theoretical grounding linked to practice

Kounin's work on classroom management (1970) helped me interpret the preventive role of clear expectations and lesson momentum. I could relate these ideas to my collaborative management activity: students needed to understand the conduct that would allow a lesson to proceed. Withitness, meaning the teacher's awareness of what is happening across the class, helped me reflect on attending to the whole class rather than responding only after a disruption. I did not measure withitness or momentum separately.

I related my two activities to Positive Discipline's emphasis on mutual respect, encouragement and responsibility. Collaborative expectations gave me a way to involve students in classroom conduct, while recognition allowed me to acknowledge behaviour that supported learning. I regarded that recognition as feedback about an action, not a judgement of a student's worth. I did not deliver the complete published programme; I drew on these principles to understand my approach.

I also considered the restorative emphasis on relationships and repairing harm. Augustine and colleagues (2018) provide an example of research on a school-based restorative programme. This perspective helped me think about responding to conflict without relying on punishment. I did not conduct that programme or a formal reflection circle, but I would consider a supported reflection circle in future where it was appropriate and safe.

Zimmerman's account of self-regulation (2002) helped me consider how students might become more aware of their own conduct. In my activities, shared expectations provided a reference and recognition drew attention to behaviour that met it. I saw these as possible supports for self-monitoring, but I did not measure independent self-regulation. I would consider weekly reflection slips in a later cycle rather than treat them as part of the work I completed here.

Theoretical idea	Connection with the completed work	Limits of my application
Awareness and momentum	Shared expectations support prevention of disruption	I did not measure these ideas separately
Mutual respect and responsibility	Collaborative management and respectful recognition	I did not deliver the full programme
Relationship repair	Helps interpret the non-punitive stance	I did not conduct formal reflection circles
Self-monitoring	Expectations and recognition give behavioural reference points	I did not measure self-regulation

I use these ideas to clarify and evaluate the approach. The classroom observations, rather than the theory alone, determine the conclusions about this class.

5. Research design and methodology

I used a practitioner action-research approach, combining observation parameters with reflective field notes. I identified a classroom problem, selected two activities, used them in my teaching and considered the change I noticed. My observation was structured around particular areas of conduct, and my records were mainly descriptive.

I worked with the thirty-eight students of Class VIII B as an intact class. I did not select a random sample, use a control group or divide students into different intervention groups. My findings therefore concern this class and my internship period rather than a wider student population.

I made my initial observations from 17 to 31 July. I recorded the nature of the difficulties. Later, I noticed that discipline had improved slightly as students became familiar with me, and I felt that collaborative management and positive recognition had helped.

I followed a practical cycle of observation, planning, action and reflection. My observations helped me choose non-punitive responses. I then used collaborative management and recognition and reviewed the slight improvement I noticed, while considering other possible influences. I completed my reflection before the examination period and did not carry out the additional October evaluation I had initially planned.

6. Operational definitions and observation parameters

I treated an action as a discipline difficulty when it interrupted an instruction, a learning activity or a school routine, or created conflict or a safety concern. I distinguished this from appropriate classroom discussion. By non-punitive management, I meant using expectations, acknowledgement and respectful correction without humiliation or physical punishment. I still had a responsibility to respond to unsafe conduct.

I used the six areas below to organise my understanding of the problem and my reflections. They helped me describe conduct more precisely than a general label of indiscipline. Their outcomes remain qualitative.

Parameter	Operational focus	What I recorded
Following instructions	Beginning or changing an action after a clear direction	Initial difficulty recorded; no separate endline rate
Conduct during transitions	Appropriate conduct around assembly, breaks and dispersal	Initial concerns recorded; no timed transition measure
Peer conduct	Disagreement without verbal escalation or physical conflict	Arguments and occasional physical conflict recorded initially
Attention and participation	Engagement with the lesson without obstructing others	Initial inattention and interrupted activities recorded
My relationship with the class	Respectful response and interaction	Comparative initial difficulty; later increased familiarity

Parameter	Operational focus	What I recorded
Lesson continuity	Ability to proceed with a planned activity	Initial disruption recorded; no count of completed lessons

I recognised that these areas could overlap. One argument could affect peer conduct, participation and lesson continuity at the same time. A percentage measure would require a defined unit of observation, criterion and denominator.

7. Baseline observations

During my initial observations, I found that students did not consistently follow instructions in class or during assembly, breaks and dispersal. I was concerned that the difficulty extended beyond one kind of lesson. My notes do not establish which time or routine was most affected.

I observed peer arguments and occasional physical altercations. I understood that these required a different response from ordinary off-task conversation. Physical conflict raised an immediate safety concern for which I needed appropriate support from the regular teacher or school authorities. Choosing a non-punitive approach did not remove that responsibility.

I found that disruption prevented some planned activities from being conducted properly and affected students who wanted to study. This gave me a clear reason to investigate the problem. I also avoided treating the whole class as uniformly disruptive: the recurring problems did not mean that all thirty-eight students behaved in the same way.

The difference I noticed between students' responses to me and to regular teachers made me reconsider my own position. I was still developing familiarity and relationships, whereas regular teachers already had continuity with the class. I saw this as a plausible part of the explanation. I could not conclude that students deliberately misbehaved only because they expected no punishment from me.

8. Collaborative classroom management

I selected collaborative classroom management because I needed students to respond more consistently to instructions and respect the conditions required for learning. I involved them in classroom expectations so that conduct could be understood as a shared responsibility. I remained responsible for guiding the lesson and responding to unsafe behaviour.

I focused the activity on the expectations needed for our class to function. In planning it, I intended to invite students to consider what helped and hindered learning and to use their ideas in developing an agreement. I can describe that purpose and my use of collaborative management, but cannot give exact numbers of groups, rules or occasions on which an agreement was displayed.

I wanted students to follow instructions more dependably and give others an opportunity to learn. During the period in which I used collaborative management and recognition, I noticed

a slight improvement in discipline. I felt that collaborative management helped, but I had not collected observations that would allow me to separate its effect from recognition or increasing familiarity with me.

I learned that involving students in expectations was only a starting point. I still needed to make those expectations understandable and use them consistently. In another cycle, I would pay closer attention to how students responded when I revisited an expectation.

9. Positive recognition system

I also used a positive recognition system to acknowledge conduct that supported the class. The initial problem was that disruption repeatedly drew attention and interrupted teaching. Recognition provided a way to direct attention towards the conduct I wanted students to continue, while keeping the response within a respectful, non-punitive approach.

I used recognition to acknowledge desirable classroom conduct. My plan was to connect recognition with the action I wanted students to continue, rather than compare their personal worth.

I wanted recognition to encourage students to meet our shared expectations and participate without disrupting others. I felt that it helped during the period of slight improvement. My records do not establish whether it helped already cooperative students more than students involved in conflict.

Reflecting on this activity, I realised that I needed to make clear what I was recognising. Otherwise, students could experience recognition as arbitrary. I also needed to notice quieter participation rather than focus only on visible contributions. I did not measure how evenly recognition was distributed in this inquiry; I would keep that record in a later cycle.

10. Relationship between the two activities and the outcome

Activity	Purpose and intended change	Observation and limits
Collaborative classroom management	Instructions and expectations were not followed consistently Shared understanding of conduct that supports learning	I considered it helpful within the slight overall improvement I did not measure its effect separately
Positive recognition	Disruption repeatedly dominated classroom attention More attention to desirable conduct	I considered it helpful within the same improvement I did not retain recognition tallies or individual response records

I used both activities while my relationship with the class was developing. I thought they could support each other: collaborative management clarified the conduct I expected, and recognition acknowledged it. I did not compare them separately, so I cannot rank one as more effective or identify either as the sole cause of improvement.

I had also considered peer responsibility and reflection circles, a settling-in routine and weekly goal slips. I did not complete those activities within this inquiry. I have kept them among my future options rather than include them in my account of the intervention I carried out.

11. Findings and interpretation

Structured observation and numerical findings

The findings are based on my qualitative observations. The observation parameters helped me organise what I noticed, but the available records do not support baseline and endline discipline percentages or a numerical gain.

In another cycle, I would define exactly what I was counting before calculating a percentage. For example, I could divide the number of sampled lessons meeting a stated instruction-following criterion by the total number of sampled lessons and multiply by one hundred. That would describe lessons, not the percentage of students who improved.

Qualitative reflective findings

By the time I concluded my observation before examinations, I had noticed a slight improvement in discipline. Students had become more familiar with me, and I felt that my two activities had helped. This was my classroom judgement rather than an independently measured result. It encouraged me to continue a structured and respectful approach, while remaining cautious about the size and duration of the change.

Theme	What I initially noticed	My interpretation
Following instructions	Difficulties in lessons and routines	Overall improvement cannot be converted into a separate compliance rate
Transitions	Concerns during assembly, breaks and dispersal	No measured reduction in settling time established
Peer conflict	Arguments and occasional physical conflict	No verified count showing the reduction or elimination of conflict
Participation	Inattention and interrupted activities	No individual participation gains established
My relationship with the class	Conduct differed from that with regular teachers	Greater familiarity accompanied the slight improvement
Lesson continuity	Activities could not always proceed properly	No numerical lesson-completion improvement established

I found limited qualitative support for my expectation that the approach would help discipline. I did not test the hypothesis statistically or establish improvement in every observation parameter. My conclusion is therefore confined to the modest overall change I noticed.

12. Discussion and professional reflection

I came to see familiarity as an influence that I needed to take seriously. Students' responses changed as they got to know me, while I was also using the activities. I could not attribute the initial difficulty entirely to my limited authority or the later improvement entirely to the strategies. Clearer expectations, repeated contact and respectful interaction may all have contributed.

The two activities gave me ways to address discipline within everyday teaching. Through collaborative management, I focused on what our class needed in order to learn. Through recognition, I acknowledged conduct that supported that aim. I found it useful to connect management with the lesson rather than allow every interruption to become a separate confrontation.

I could not explain from my notes why particular students were less responsive or which activity worked best for them. Task understanding, peer relationships, habits and the way I communicated expectations were all possibilities I needed to consider. In a future inquiry, I would observe individual responses more closely instead of assigning an explanation without enough evidence.

I also considered the possible effect of repetition and consistency. Students needed to understand my expectations across lessons, and recognition needed to relate to clear conduct. A manageable routine and a brief implementation record would make a later evaluation more useful.

My internship timetable limited the continuity and time I could give to the inquiry. Examinations, festivals and unfinished chapter teaching reduced the opportunity for a longer cycle. I therefore closed the study with the modest improvement I had observed, while recognising that I had not established how long it would last.

13. Researcher bias reliability and ethical limits

I implemented the activities and evaluated the outcome. This dual role creates a risk that I noticed improvements that fitted my expectations or gave them more weight than continuing difficulties. There was no independent observer to check the interpretation. The observation checklist was locally developed, and its reliability was not established through shared rating or repeated coding.

Behaviour can vary between lessons, topics and classroom conditions. A calmer lesson is not necessarily evidence of lasting change. No control group or matched comparison was used, so the study cannot separate the activities from growing familiarity, timetable changes or other influences. The findings apply primarily to this classroom and internship period.

I kept initial notes and reflected on the later change, but I did not maintain a complete series of dated field notes, numerical incident tallies, a consistently applied rating scale or independently checked activity logs. I did not measure teaching time lost, transitions, participation or lesson completion separately. I did not retain the final classroom agreement, detailed group-discussion

records, a recognition chart, weekly tallies or a complete list of recognition recipients. Without dated session logs, weekly records and individual response records, I cannot judge changes at particular stages, compare students' responses or measure how often each activity was used. I also did not collect student interviews or conduct matched observations across teachers. These gaps limit the precision and independent verification of my interpretation.

I have protected students' identities and focused on conduct and learning conditions rather than personal labels. I did not regard a student as a troublemaker or assume a motive without examining it. I also recognised that serious conflict required appropriate school support; reflection alone would not replace my responsibility to protect the students involved.

14. Recommendations and future action research

At teacher and intern level, I would continue collaborative expectations and specific recognition, while keeping a brief record of the conduct observed and the response used. I would make instructions clear, check that students understand the task and seek support where conflict threatens safety. Students with repeated difficulties would need an individual review rather than repeated whole-class reminders alone.

At school level, interns would benefit from a clear explanation of routines, responsibilities and the route for requesting help. Coordination with the regular teacher could reduce uncertainty about expectations and follow-up. This recommendation does not assume that such coordination was absent; it identifies the support needed for consistent classroom practice.

At teacher-education level, preparation should include interpreting behaviour, setting expectations, giving respectful corrective feedback and keeping usable observation records. A short observation by a mentor, followed by discussion, could help a trainee compare personal impressions with another perspective. It would also make the research component of the internship more closely connected with ordinary teaching decisions.

Next research step	Question it would answer	What I would record
Longer behaviour tracking	Does improvement persist?	Repeated observations using consistent criteria
Individual support	Which students need a different response?	Private behaviour profiles and contextual notes
Independent mentor observation	How similar are two observers' judgements?	Shared definitions and separately recorded observations
Matched teacher comparison	How does conduct vary with intern and regular teachers?	Comparable lessons and careful contextual records
Student voice where permitted	How do students understand expectations and recognition?	Ethically collected interviews or brief responses
Follow-up after the intervention	Does conduct remain improved without the same support?	Delayed observations rather than an immediate impression

In a future cycle, I would consider peer responsibility and reflection circles for supported conflict review, a settling-in routine for transitions and weekly reflection slips for self-monitoring. I would choose among these options according to the difficulty I observed and evaluate the response without expecting a predetermined percentage gain.

15. Conclusion

I addressed the recurring disruption in Class VIII B through collaborative classroom management and a positive recognition system. I noticed a slight improvement in discipline as students became more familiar with me, and I felt that the activities helped. I could not measure an exact gain or establish one cause. The experience taught me to connect clear expectations with respectful interaction and to keep better records if I wanted to evaluate change more precisely.

References

School Internship Handbook 2026. Module 5 format and assessment rubric.

Kounin, J. S. (1970). Discipline and group management in classrooms. Holt, Rinehart and Winston.

Positive Discipline. (n.d.). About Positive Discipline. https://www.positivediscipline.com/about-positive-discipline/

Augustine, C. H., Engberg, J., Grimm, G. E., Lee, E., Wang, E. L., Christianson, K., and Joseph, A. A. (2018). Can restorative practices improve school climate and curb suspensions? RAND Corporation. https://doi.org/10.7249/RR2840

Zimmerman, B. J. (2002). Becoming a self-regulated learner: An overview. Theory Into Practice, 41(2), 64–70. https://doi.org/10.1207/s15430421tip4102_2

I have drawn on my handwritten initial observations, my activity plan and my reflection on the two activities I conducted before examinations. I used the references to interpret my approach, while grounding my conclusions about this class in what I actually observed.